

IDBI's Linux portfolio

Year	Linux deployment
2001	Enterprise e-mail server and IVRS applications
2002	Jabber for messaging
2003	Oracle ERP on Linux
2009	Web Server, DNS and LDAP server

customers and reinforcing our image as a customer- and technology-savvy bank," vouches Sharma.

Looking ahead, IDBI is in the process of implementing a new version of the e-mail solution, including archival solutions based on open source architecture. "The set-up includes cluster and virtualisation technology on Linux. Users will be able to access e-mail from the Web and smart phones. They can also access the calendar and contacts on smart phones, which can be synced with PIM (personal information manager) applications," says Sharma.

A 'thumbs up' for open source in banks

Thus, it's a 'thumbs up' to open source deployment in banks, especially now with more vendors offering/porting solutions on open source.

Advising other banks/institutions deploying open source for business critical information, Sharma says: "Banks must increase the use of open

source in the front office, where it is still at a nascent stage. Banks can use Eclipse, an integrated development environment (IDE) for Java, to develop complex trading/internet banking systems. ERP applications on open source platforms can cut costs and achieve stability. Further, there are open source data analytics software and a host of financial applications. Linux also supports advanced networking features. Besides a reliable TCP/UDP/IP protocol stack, features like firewalls, quality of service (QoS), tunnelling, etc, have been added to the OS kernel."

QoS support in Linux encompasses a description of the differentiated services effort, firewall implementation using IP chains, VPN implementation using GRE tunnels and advanced routing implementation using Netlink sockets.

Guess it's high time banks stopped hesitating and started banking on open source, not only because of greater reliability and cost savings, but for the benefits it offers its customers. **END** 

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The author loves to experiment and writing for LINUX For You is her latest experiment. So, beware! Just a minute, she also happens to be a journalist during the day.



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